Besides he is also known as the pioneer of estimation theory, analysis of variance, and design of experiments. Hence he is known as the father of Statistics.

12.2 Evolution of Statistics in India


Prof. P.C.Mahalanobis

Evidence from history proves that during the reign of Chandra Gupta Maurya, there existed a system of maintaining vital statistics, including registration of births and deaths. Such records can be found in Kautilya's Arthashastra even before 300B.C. The book "Ain-e-Akbari" (1596-97) mentions the statistical and administrative surveys conducted during Akbar's rule. P.C.Mahalanobis is known as the founder of modern statistics and also as father of Statistics in India. Since 2007 29th of June every year is celebrated as Statistics Day to commemorate his birth anniversary.

12.3 Definitions of Statistics

The term 'Statistics' is used in two senses: as singular and plural. In singular form it simply means statistical methods. Statistics when used in singular form helps in the collection, presentation, classification and interpretation of data to make it easily comprehensible. In its plural form it denotes collection of numerical figures and facts. In the narrow sense it has been defined as the science of counting and science of averages.

Definitions of Statistics

Statistics as a science of estimates and probabilities

- Boddington

Statistics may be defined as the collection, organisation, presentation, analysis and interpretation of numerical data

- Croxton & Cowden

12.4 Characteristics and Functions of Statistics

i) **Statistics are an aggregate of facts.** For example, numbers in a calendar pertaining to a year will not be called statistics, but to be included in statistics it should contain a series of figures with relationships for a prolonged period.

ii) **Statistics are numerically enumerated, estimated and expressed.**

iii) **Statistical collection should be systematic with a predetermined purpose:** The purpose of collection of statistics should be determined beforehand in order to get accurate information.

iv) **Should be capable of being used as a technique for drawing comparison:** It should be capable of drawing comparison between two different sets of data by tools such as averages, ratios, rates, coefficients etc.

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